

MARBLE EFFECTS LAB

BONUS GUIDE

From Zero to Your First *\$1,000* Job

How to price, find clients, build a portfolio, and
position yourself as a premium marble wall finisher
— even with zero experience.

01

How to Price Marble Wall Services

Pricing is where most beginners either leave money on the table or price themselves out of the market. Here's the formula that works:

THE SIMPLE PRICING FORMULA

Materials + (Hours x Rate) + 30% Profit = Your Price

Your rate should be \$50-\$100/hour minimum for marble effects. You're not a painter — you're a specialist.

REAL-WORLD PRICING EXAMPLES

Project	Size	Materials	Time	Your Price
Accent wall — Carrara White	3m x 2.5m (10×8ft)	\$40-60	3-4 hours	\$350-500
Bathroom feature wall	2m x 2.5m (6.5×8ft)	\$30-50	3 hours	\$300-450
Full living room (4 walls)	~40 sqm (~430 sqft)	\$200-350	2-3 days	\$2,000-3,500
Fireplace surround	~3 sqm (~32 sqft)	\$25-40	2-3 hours	\$300-500
Bar front / reception desk	~5 sqm (~54 sqft)	\$50-80	4-6 hours	\$500-800
Premium onyx / exotic effect	3m x 2.5m	\$60-100	5-8 hours	\$600-1,200

Key insight: Never price by square footage alone. Price by complexity. A 3-meter Carrara wall takes 3 hours; a 3-meter Honey Onyx wall takes 6-8 hours. The Onyx should cost 2-3x more.

HOW TO PRESENT YOUR PRICE

1. Always present the price as an investment, not a cost: "For this feature wall in Calacatta Gold, the investment is \$650. That includes all materials, preparation, application, and a professional sealer that protects it for years."

2. Compare to the alternative: "Real Calacatta Gold marble slabs would run \$15,000-25,000 for this wall, plus installation. You get the same stunning look for a fraction of the cost."
3. Never apologize for your pricing. You are offering a specialized skill that takes training and artistic ability. Own it.

02

Finding Your First Clients

You don't need a massive following or years of experience. You need three to five completed projects, and here's how to get them:

STRATEGY 1: START AT HOME

Do your own home first. Pick the wall that gets the most attention — the living room accent wall, the bathroom, or the fireplace. This becomes your first portfolio piece and your most powerful sales tool.

STRATEGY 2: FRIENDS & FAMILY DISCOUNT

Offer the first 3-5 jobs at a steep discount (cost of materials + \$100-200) in exchange for:

- Permission to photograph the finished wall professionally
- A written testimonial or video review
- Permission to post the before/after on your social media

You're not losing money — you're building a portfolio that will earn you thousands.

STRATEGY 3: SOCIAL MEDIA (FREE)

- **Instagram / TikTok:** Post before/after transformations. These go viral consistently — people love watching walls transform. Use hashtags like #marblewall #fauxmarble #wallart #marbleeffect #interiordesign.
- **Facebook Groups:** Join local home renovation, interior design, and DIY groups. Don't sell — share your work. People will ask "who did this?" and "how much?"
- **Nextdoor / local community apps:** Post your work. Neighbors hire neighbors.

STRATEGY 4: PARTNER WITH EXISTING BUSINESSES

- **Interior designers** — They need sub-contractors for specialty finishes. Offer to do one demo wall for their showroom.
- **Real estate agents** — A marble accent wall can increase a home's perceived value. Offer to stage a home with a feature wall.
- **General contractors / painters** — They get asked for specialty finishes and don't know how to do them. Become their go-to specialist.
- **Home staging companies** — They want wow-factor improvements at low cost.

STRATEGY 5: LOCAL ADVERTISING

- Google Business Profile (free) — set up with photos of your work
- Flyers in home improvement stores (with permission)
- Business cards left at paint stores, tile shops, and design showrooms

The fastest path to your first paid client: Do your own wall → post before/after on social media → someone asks "can you do that at my place?" → quote them → do the job → photograph it → post again → repeat. Most of our users get their first paid inquiry within 2 weeks of posting their first transformation.

03

Building Your Portfolio

Your portfolio is your most powerful sales tool. Here's how to build one that sells:

WHAT TO PHOTOGRAPH

- **Before:** The bare or old wall, well-lit, from the same angle you'll use for the "after" shot.
- **During:** A few process shots showing you at work — spatula in hand, materials laid out, the wall half-completed. This proves it's your work and shows the craft.
- **After:** The finished wall, well-lit, styled with furniture/decor if possible. Natural daylight is best. Shoot from straight-on and at a slight angle to show texture.
- **Detail shots:** Close-up of the veining, texture, and sheen. These show quality craftsmanship.

PHOTO TIPS

1. Clean the area before photographing — no drop cloths, tape, or mess visible.
2. Use natural light. If the room is dark, add two LED work lights — one direct, one bounced off the ceiling for even fill.
3. Shoot with your phone in landscape mode, camera at chest height.
4. Include something for scale — a piece of furniture, a vase, a plant next to the wall.
5. Edit lightly — adjust brightness and contrast, but don't filter heavily. The work should speak for itself.

WHERE TO DISPLAY YOUR PORTFOLIO

- Instagram grid (your top 9 posts should all be your best work)
- A simple website or landing page with before/after galleries
- A physical portfolio on your tablet — show it to clients in person
- Google Business Profile photos
- Print a few large photos for home shows or consultations

USING THE CLIENT CATALOG AS A SALES TOOL

The Client-Ready Design Catalog included in your package is designed for exactly this. When meeting a potential client:

1. Open the catalog on your tablet or hand them the printed version

2. Let them browse through the 30+ designs
3. When they find one they like, show them your portfolio shots of similar work
4. Quote the job on the spot using the pricing formula from Chapter 1
5. Close with: "I can start as early as [date]. This wall will take [X] hours and will be fully cured within [Y] days."

04

Positioning Yourself as a Premium Finisher

The difference between charging \$200 for a wall and \$800 for a wall is positioning, not skill level. Here's how to position yourself at the premium end:

YOU ARE NOT A PAINTER

Never call yourself a painter. You are a:

- Decorative finisher
- Faux marble specialist
- Artisan wall finisher
- Luxury wall effects artist

The label matters. "Painter" implies \$25-50/hour commodity work. "Decorative finisher" implies \$75-150/hour specialty work.

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION

- **Arrive prepared:** Clean vehicle, organized materials, professional appearance. Not paint-splattered jeans from yesterday's job.
- **Protect the space:** Drop cloths, tape, covered furniture before you start. Show the client you respect their home.
- **Leave it cleaner than you found it:** Clean up completely. No dust, no residue, no marks. This is what gets you referrals.

THE CONSULTATION PROCESS

1. **Visit the space.** Never quote without seeing the wall. Check the surface condition, lighting, and room layout.
2. **Listen first.** What look are they going for? What's the room used for? What's their budget range? Let them talk.
3. **Show the catalog.** Let them pick, then guide them based on the room's lighting and existing decor.
4. **Show a sample.** If possible, bring a small sample board of their chosen effect. This is powerful — it makes the abstract tangible.

5. **Quote confidently.** Present the price, explain what's included, and compare to the cost of real stone. Then stop talking.

GETTING REFERRALS

Your best marketing is a satisfied client. After completing a job:

- Ask for a Google review — in person, before you leave. "Would you mind leaving a quick review on Google? It really helps my business."
- Leave 3-5 business cards with the client — "If anyone asks about your wall, I'd appreciate the referral."
- Follow up in 2 weeks with a text: "Hi [name], just checking in — how's the wall holding up? Feel free to share my contact if anyone's interested."

Your first \$1,000 job path: One accent wall at \$350-500 leads to a referral. That referral leads to a full bathroom (\$800-1,200). That bathroom photo on Instagram gets you a full living room (\$2,000-3,500). Within 3-6 months of your first job, a \$1,000+ project is inevitable — most people hit it much sooner.

05

Your Starter Kit Checklist

Everything you need to get started. Total investment: approximately \$150-250 depending on your local prices.

ESSENTIAL TOOLS

Item	Est. Cost	Where to Buy
Stainless steel spatula (8-10cm flexible)	\$12-20	Hardware store, Amazon
Wide stainless steel trowel (20-25cm)	\$15-25	Hardware store
Mixing palette / flat surface	\$5-10	Art supply store
Sandpaper pack (220, 320, 400 grit)	\$8-12	Hardware store
Spray bottle	\$3-5	Any store
Painter's tape (2 rolls)	\$8-12	Hardware store
Lint-free cloths (pack)	\$6-10	Hardware store
Drop cloths (2)	\$10-15	Hardware store

ESSENTIAL MATERIALS (FOR YOUR FIRST PROJECT)

Item	Est. Cost	Notes
White acrylic putty / decorative stucco (5 kg)	\$20-35	The main material — buy quality
Universal pigments (black, raw umber, burnt sienna, yellow ochre, white)	\$25-40	Small tubes last a long time
Acrylic bonding primer (1 L)	\$10-15	Essential for adhesion

Item	Est. Cost	Notes
White base paint (1 L)	\$10-15	For most marble recipes
Clear sealer — matte or satin (500 ml)	\$15-25	Protects the finished effect
Sample board (MDF, 60×60cm)	\$5-8	Practice before the real wall

Total starter investment: \$150-250. Your first job at \$350-500 more than covers it. Every job after that is mostly profit.

YOUR ACTION PLAN

1. Buy your starter kit materials this week
2. Practice Carrara White (Recipe 01) on a sample board
3. Practice a second effect — try Travertine (06) or Thunder Grey (18)
4. Do your first full wall at home
5. Photograph before, during, and after
6. Post before/after on Instagram and Facebook
7. Offer 3 discounted jobs to friends/family for portfolio
8. Quote your first full-price job with confidence
9. Do the job, photograph it, collect a testimonial
10. Repeat, improve, raise your prices

You have everything you need. Now go build something beautiful.